

FACILITATOR ONLY / CONTAINS ASSET MAPPINGS

YOUTH FINANCETOPIA CHALLENGE

Newsroom & facilitator guide

Quarter-by-quarter market cards, source anchors, teaching notes and classroom safeguards.

2018-2022

VERSION 2.0
10 JULY 2026

CLASSROOM SIMULATION - NOT INVESTMENT ADVICE

Prices are simplified and rounded teaching traces. Headlines compress real themes into a fictional game timeline. Rumors are invented. Do not present the cards as dated historical reporting or as recommendations to buy or sell.

Students should receive fake names only. Keep this guide off the student-facing site until the debrief.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Keep the uncertainty. Teach the process.

The challenge works when students must decide what matters without being handed the real ticker, the future path or a perfect answer. The website releases only the current quarter's cards and only historical chart points earned so far.

1 / BRIEF

Ask teams to open confirmed briefs first. Let them paraphrase the fact before discussing direction.

2 / QUESTION

Use the card's question to surface competing explanations. Reward a team that identifies what it still does not know.

3 / RUMOR

Reveal desk chatter only after the fact is understood. It may be useful, irrelevant or false; students must label it as unverified.

4 / DECIDE

Teams pin evidence, choose a view and confidence, write one sentence, then review quantity and estimated cash before the captain confirms.

Facilitator guardrails

- Never reveal the real mapping during live play.
- Do not tell teams which asset should rise or fall.
- Treat a well-reasoned hold as a valid decision.
- Separate outcome quality from decision quality in the debrief.
- Explain that all company and market references are historical classroom context, not current financial or medical guidance.

FACILITATOR KEY

Fake asset map

This page contains the answer key. The student website and student handouts must use fake names only.

GAME NAME	REAL-WORLD TRACE	TEACHING ROLE
Stock A	Meta Platforms / Facebook	Advertising, privacy, platform growth and rate sensitivity
Stock B	Occidental Petroleum	Commodity exposure, acquisition leverage and balance-sheet repair
Stock C	Eli Lilly	Defensive sales, research catalysts and manufacturing execution
Metal D	Gold	Safe-haven demand, real yields, dollar strength and liquidity
Energy E	Crude oil, mainly WTI	Demand, supply, storage, sanctions and trade routes
FX Pair F	EUR/USD	Relative policy, growth expectations and dollar cycles
Fear Gauge G	Cboe VIX	Broad-market expected volatility from SPX options

Accuracy notes that matter

FEAR GAUGE G

The VIX is based on S&P 500 index option prices and represents expected broad-market volatility. Meme-stock or single-stock call volume does not directly enter its calculation. A broad gauge can look calm while individual shares are chaotic. VIX products exist in real markets; the gauge is simply not tradable in this simulation.

FX PAIR F

The proxy follows EUR/USD quote direction: a higher value means euro strength and dollar weakness; a lower value means dollar strength. Students need this convention before interpreting a move.

MEDICAL HISTORY

The 2020 emergency-use card is a known-at-the-time historical scenario. FDA later revoked authorization for bamlanivimab when used alone. Do not treat the card as current medical guidance.

2018 NEWSROOM

Quarter cards: 2018

Release each card only when its game quarter is reached. Source IDs point to the appendix; the card wording is a fictionalized synthesis rather than a quotation.

2018 Q1 / STOCK A**Questions grow around customer data****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Lawmakers want clearer answers about how a large consumer network handles personal information. Advertisers have not changed their plans yet.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

A costly product redesign may be discussed behind closed doors.

ASK THE ROOM

Is this a short-term headline, or could it change the business model?

DEBRIEF LENS

Separate user attention from advertiser economics, then add regulation and discount-rate risk.

SOURCE IDS

S01, S02

2018 Q1 / STOCK C**A steady business hints at another trial update****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Core medicine sales remain dependable while researchers prepare a new pipeline presentation.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Specialists think the pipeline may be broader than investors expect.

ASK THE ROOM

How much should a possible future result matter today?

DEBRIEF LENS

Distinguish dependable core sales from uncertain trial, approval and capacity outcomes.

SOURCE IDS

S12

2018 Q2 / ENERGY E**Supply looks tight - for now****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Export disruptions are supporting energy prices, but weekly inventory declines are becoming less consistent.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Some shipping desks say hidden stockpiles are building.

ASK THE ROOM

Which matters more: today's shortage or tomorrow's inventory?

DEBRIEF LENS

Trace the physical chain: demand, production response, storage and regional transport limits.

SOURCE IDS

S19, S33

2018 NEWSROOM / CONTINUED

Quarter cards: 2018

Continue the same release rule: no card appears before its game quarter.

2018 Q3 / STOCK B**Board studies a large expansion****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

An energy producer is exploring a deal that could increase output and also increase debt.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Management may announce something larger than the market expects.

ASK THE ROOM

When does growth become too expensive?

DEBRIEF LENS

Ask whether stronger commodity cash flow is enough to compensate for leverage and execution risk.

SOURCE IDS

S08

2018 Q4 / METAL D**Safe-haven demand meets a strong currency****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Investors are nervous after a broad selloff, while higher yields and a firm US dollar remain headwinds for defensive metal.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

The latest bounce may be traders closing old bets rather than starting new ones.

ASK THE ROOM

Can an asset be defensive and still face macro pressure?

DEBRIEF LENS

Compare safe-haven demand with the opportunity cost created by yields and dollar strength.

SOURCE IDS

S19, S23

2019 NEWSROOM

Quarter cards: 2019

Release each card only when its game quarter is reached. Source IDs point to the appendix; the card wording is a fictionalized synthesis rather than a quotation.

2019 Q1 / STOCK A

Advertisers return, scrutiny remains

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Marketing demand is stabilizing after a difficult year, but policy questions have not disappeared.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Engagement may be improving fastest in smaller markets.

ASK THE ROOM

Does improving demand outweigh a risk that is still unresolved?

DEBRIEF LENS

Separate user attention from advertiser economics, then add regulation and discount-rate risk.

SOURCE IDS

S03

2019 Q1 / FX PAIR F

Central banks signal different paths

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Traders are comparing which central bank may ease policy first as global growth expectations soften.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Macro funds are preparing to sell every short-lived relief rally.

ASK THE ROOM

Which side of the pair has the stronger policy support?

DEBRIEF LENS

A higher proxy means euro strength and dollar weakness; compare policy and growth on both sides.

SOURCE IDS

S20, S21, S22, S32

2019 Q2 / STOCK C

Pricing debate reaches healthcare

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Politicians are discussing medicine affordability while Stock C invests in a smaller research business.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Researchers believe the acquired science may be worth more than the purchase price.

ASK THE ROOM

How do policy risk and innovation pull value in opposite directions?

DEBRIEF LENS

Distinguish dependable core sales from uncertain trial, approval and capacity outcomes.

SOURCE IDS

S13

2019 NEWSROOM / CONTINUED

Quarter cards: 2019

Continue the same release rule: no card appears before its game quarter.

2019 Q3 / METAL D**Rate cuts return to the conversation****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Trade uncertainty is rising and policy makers are becoming more willing to support growth.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Large long-term funds may be rebuilding defensive positions.

ASK THE ROOM

Would easier policy change the opportunity cost of holding metal?

DEBRIEF LENS

Compare safe-haven demand with the opportunity cost created by yields and dollar strength.

SOURCE IDS

S21, S22, S23

2019 Q4 / STOCK B**Big deal, bigger balance sheet****CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Stock B has committed to a major acquisition. Investors now have to judge the extra production against the extra debt.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Credit desks are questioning whether the dividend can stay untouched.

ASK THE ROOM

What could go right - and what must go right?

DEBRIEF LENS

Ask whether stronger commodity cash flow is enough to compensate for leverage and execution risk.

SOURCE IDS

S08

2020 NEWSROOM

Quarter cards: 2020

Release each card only when its game quarter is reached. Source IDs point to the appendix; the card wording is a fictionalized synthesis rather than a quotation.

2020 Q1 / ENERGY E

Travel stops and storage fills

CONFIRMED BRIEF

A global health emergency is cutting transport demand much faster than producers can reduce supply.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Physical traders say available storage is disappearing faster than public data suggests.

ASK THE ROOM

What happens when a physical product has nowhere to go?

DEBRIEF LENS

Trace the physical chain: demand, production response, storage and regional transport limits.

SOURCE IDS

S25, S33

2020 Q1 / FEAR GAUGE G

Stress gauge flashes red

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Option prices show investors paying unusually high amounts for protection as uncertainty spreads across markets.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Some desks are selling even their safest assets just to raise cash.

ASK THE ROOM

Does extreme fear warn of more danger, or signal forced selling?

DEBRIEF LENS

This broad-market gauge comes from SPX options. Single-stock chaos can coexist with a calm VIX.

SOURCE IDS

S28, S34

2020 Q2 / METAL D

Emergency support changes the macro picture

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Central banks and governments are launching unusually large support programs after a rush for cash.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

New buyers are treating defensive metal as insurance against the policy response.

ASK THE ROOM

Could the same policy calm markets and create a new long-term risk?

DEBRIEF LENS

Compare safe-haven demand with the opportunity cost created by yields and dollar strength.

SOURCE IDS

S24

2020 NEWSROOM / CONTINUED

Quarter cards: 2020

Continue the same release rule: no card appears before its game quarter.

2020 Q3 / STOCK A

Online activity jumps, advertising stays uneven

CONFIRMED BRIEF

People are spending more time on digital services, but many small advertisers remain under pressure.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Internal usage figures may be stronger than the company has shared publicly.

ASK THE ROOM

Which is more important for this business: attention or advertiser budgets?

DEBRIEF LENS

Separate user attention from advertiser economics, then add regulation and discount-rate risk.

SOURCE IDS

S04

2020 Q4 / STOCK C

Treatment data draws attention

CONFIRMED BRIEF

A healthcare company reports encouraging emergency-treatment evidence while its core business remains stable.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Another late-stage trial could become the larger story.

ASK THE ROOM

How should a one-off catalyst be compared with the core business?

DEBRIEF LENS

Distinguish dependable core sales from uncertain trial, approval and capacity outcomes.

SOURCE IDS

S14, S15

2021 NEWSROOM

Quarter cards: 2021

Release each card only when its game quarter is reached. Source IDs point to the appendix; the card wording is a fictionalized synthesis rather than a quotation.

2021 Q1 / STOCK B

Reopening lifts fuel expectations

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Mobility is improving and producers are still cautious about adding supply. Stock B is using stronger cash flow to repair its finances.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Value investors are quietly revisiting companies they avoided last year.

ASK THE ROOM

How quickly can better conditions repair a weak balance sheet?

DEBRIEF LENS

Ask whether stronger commodity cash flow is enough to compensate for leverage and execution risk.

SOURCE IDS

S10, S26

2021 Q2 / FEAR GAUGE

Calmer index, noisy corners

CONFIRMED BRIEF

The broad-market stress gauge is lower, even while a few individual companies are moving wildly.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Some traders warn that a calm headline index can hide risk concentrated in single stocks.

ASK THE ROOM

Can a market look calm while parts of it are unstable?

DEBRIEF LENS

This broad-market gauge comes from SPX options. Single-stock chaos can coexist with a calm VIX.

SOURCE IDS

S27, S28

2021 Q3 / STOCK C

Two research programs approach key updates

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Stock C has more than one late-stage program that could affect its future growth story.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Specialist discussions describe one dataset as unusually strong.

ASK THE ROOM

How much confidence belongs in a story before full data arrives?

DEBRIEF LENS

Distinguish dependable core sales from uncertain trial, approval and capacity outcomes.

SOURCE IDS

S16, S17

2021 Q4 / STOCK A

A new identity comes with a large bill

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Stock A is redirecting investment toward a long-term platform idea while near-term growth becomes less certain.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

The rebrand may be distracting leaders from the existing advertising engine.

ASK THE ROOM

When is long-term investment a strength, and when is it a warning?

DEBRIEF LENS

Separate user attention from advertiser economics, then add regulation and discount-rate risk.

SOURCE IDS

S05, S06

2022 NEWSROOM

Quarter cards: 2022

Release each card only when its game quarter is reached. Source IDs point to the appendix; the card wording is a fictionalized synthesis rather than a quotation.

2022 Q1 / ENERGY E

Conflict threatens a major supply route

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Sanctions and transport uncertainty are forcing buyers to rethink where energy will come from.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Regional shortages may be more severe than the global benchmark suggests.

ASK THE ROOM

Is the shock temporary, or will trade routes change for longer?

DEBRIEF LENS

Trace the physical chain: demand, production response, storage and regional transport limits.

SOURCE IDS

S30

2022 Q1 / STOCK B

Stronger prices transform the debt story

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Stock B is generating far more cash as the energy market tightens, giving management new choices about debt and shareholder returns.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

A famous long-term investor may still be adding to a position.

ASK THE ROOM

How should improved cash flow change the way you view old debt?

DEBRIEF LENS

Ask whether stronger commodity cash flow is enough to compensate for leverage and execution risk.

SOURCE IDS

S11

2022 Q2 / METAL D

War risk meets aggressive rate hikes

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Demand for protection remains, while faster policy tightening and a stronger dollar raise the cost of holding defensive metal.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Some desks expect a round trip rather than a clean trend.

ASK THE ROOM

Which force is likely to last longer?

DEBRIEF LENS

Compare safe-haven demand with the opportunity cost created by yields and dollar strength.

SOURCE IDS

S29, S31

2022 Q3 / STOCK C

A new treatment could face a supply problem

CONFIRMED BRIEF

Demand expectations for an obesity treatment are rising so quickly that manufacturing capacity is becoming part of the debate.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Early channel checks suggest demand could run ahead of production.

ASK THE ROOM

Can very strong demand still create an execution risk?

DEBRIEF LENS

Distinguish dependable core sales from uncertain trial, approval and capacity outcomes.

SOURCE IDS

S18

2022 Q4 / STOCK A

Advertisers question measurement**CONFIRMED BRIEF**

Privacy changes make digital ads harder to measure just as higher rates make distant profits less valuable.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Some buyers say the measurement problem is worse than public guidance implies.

ASK THE ROOM

Are these two separate risks, or can they reinforce each other?

DEBRIEF LENS

Separate user attention from advertiser economics, then add regulation and discount-rate risk.

SOURCE IDS

S06, S07

2022 Q4 / FX PAIR F

Rate gaps pull currencies apart**CONFIRMED BRIEF**

One central bank is tightening faster while energy costs put different pressure on the two economies behind FX Pair F.

FICTIONAL RUMOR

Positioning may be crowded after a long move in the same direction.

ASK THE ROOM

Does a strong trend become safer or riskier when everyone sees it?

DEBRIEF LENS

A higher proxy means euro strength and dollar weakness; compare policy and growth on both sides.

SOURCE IDS

S29, S32

DEBRIEF TOOLKIT

Make the reasoning visible

Use these prompts after results are marked. Ask for evidence before showing the real mapping.

**FACT, RUMOR OR
INFERENCE?**

Choose one statement your team used. Was it confirmed information, unverified chatter or your own conclusion?

**WHAT CHANGED
YOUR MIND?**

Name the single clue or price move that caused the largest update to your view.

**WAS
CONFIDENCE
CALIBRATED?**

Compare your stated confidence with the strength and independence of your evidence.

**OUTCOME
VERSUS PROCESS**

Would you make the same decision again with the same information, even if the result was poor?

**WHAT STAYED
HIDDEN?**

List information a real analyst would still want before making a larger decision.

Plain-language glossary

Catalyst An event that could change expectations or price.	Hedge A position intended to reduce another risk.
Leverage Debt or borrowing that can magnify gains and losses.	Liquidity How easily an asset can be traded without a large price change.
Rate differential The gap between interest rates in two economies.	Real yield An interest rate after accounting for expected inflation.
Short covering Buying that closes an earlier bet on a falling price.	Volatility How widely and quickly prices move.

SOURCE APPENDIX

Authoritative anchors

These sources calibrate historical themes and the simplified proxy traces. They do not turn a fictional card into a dated transcript. Access checks were completed on 10 July 2026.

Stock A

- | | |
|------------|--|
| S01 | Statement on reported concerns about Facebook privacy practices
Federal Trade Commission / 2018-03-26
https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2018/03/statement-acting-director-ftcs-bureau-consumer-protection-regarding-reported-concerns-about-facebook |
| S02 | Facebook reports second quarter 2018 results
Facebook / 2018-07-25
https://investor.fb.com/files/doc_financials/2018/Q2/Facebook-Reports-Second-Quarter-2018-Results.pdf |
| S03 | Facebook reports fourth quarter and full year 2019 results
Meta Investor Relations / 2020-01-29
https://investor.atmeta.com/investor-news/press-release-details/2020/Facebook-Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-2019-Results/default.aspx |
| S04 | Facebook reports fourth quarter and full year 2020 results
Meta Investor Relations / 2021-01-27
https://investor.atmeta.com/investor-news/press-release-details/2021/Facebook-Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-2020-Results/default.aspx |
| S05 | Introducing Meta: a social technology company
Meta / 2021-10-28
https://about.fb.com/news/2021/10/facebook-company-is-now-meta/ |
| S06 | Meta reports fourth quarter and full year 2021 results
Meta Investor Relations / 2022-02-02
https://investor.atmeta.com/investor-news/press-release-details/2022/Meta-Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-2021-Results/default.aspx |
| S07 | Meta reports fourth quarter and full year 2022 results
Meta Investor Relations / 2023-02-01
https://investor.atmeta.com/investor-news/press-release-details/2023/Meta-Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-2022-Results/default.aspx |

Stock B

- | | |
|------------|---|
| S08 | Occidental completes acquisition of Anadarko
U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission archive / 2019-08-08
https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/797468/000095015719000864/ex99-1.htm |
| S09 | Occidental announces fourth quarter and full year 2020 results
Occidental Petroleum / 2021-02-22
https://www.oxy.com/siteassets/documents/investors/quarterly-earnings/OXY4Q20EarningsRelease.pdf |
| S10 | Occidental announces fourth quarter 2021 results
Occidental Petroleum / 2022-02-24
https://www.oxy.com/siteassets/documents/investors/quarterly-earnings/oxy4q21earningspressrelease_financials2.pdf |
| S11 | Occidental announces fourth quarter 2022 results
Occidental Petroleum / 2023-02-27
https://www.oxy.com/news/news-releases/occidental-announces-4th-quarter-2022-results/ |

Stock C

S12	Lilly reports fourth quarter and full year 2018 financial results Eli Lilly / 2019-02-06 https://investor.lilly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/lilly-reports-strong-fourth-quarter-and-full-year-2018-financial
S13	Lilly to acquire Loxo Oncology Eli Lilly / 2019-01-07 https://investor.lilly.com/node/40136
S14	FDA authorizes monoclonal antibody treatment for COVID-19 U.S. Food and Drug Administration / 2020-11-09 https://www.fda.gov/news-events/press-announcements/coronavirus-covid-19-update-fda-authorizes-monoclonal-antibody-treatment-covid-19
S15	FDA revokes authorization for bamlanivimab when administered alone U.S. Food and Drug Administration / 2021-04-16 https://www.fda.gov/news-events/press-announcements/coronavirus-covid-19-update-fda-revokes-emergency-use-authorization-monoclonal-antibody-bamlanivimab
S16	Tirzepatide achieves primary and key secondary study endpoints Eli Lilly / 2021-05-20 https://investor.lilly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/lillys-tirzepatide-achieves-all-primary-and-key-secondary-study
S17	Donanemab receives FDA Breakthrough Therapy designation Eli Lilly / 2021-06-24 https://investor.lilly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/lillys-donanemab-receives-us-fdas-breakthrough-therapy
S18	SURMOUNT-1 tirzepatide obesity trial results Eli Lilly / 2022-04-28 https://investor.lilly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/lillys-tirzepatide-delivered-225-weight-loss-adults-obesity-or

Macro and energy

S19	Crude oil prices declined in fourth quarter 2018 U.S. Energy Information Administration / 2019-01-03 https://www.eia.gov/todayinenergy/detail.php?id=37852
S20	Federal Reserve issues FOMC statement Federal Reserve / 2019-03-20 https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/pressreleases/monetary20190320a.htm
S21	Federal Reserve issues FOMC statement Federal Reserve / 2019-07-31 https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/pressreleases/monetary20190731a.htm
S22	ECB monetary policy decisions European Central Bank / 2019-09-12 https://www.ecb.europa.eu/press/pr/date/2019/html/ecb.mp190912~08de50b4d2.en.html
S23	Gold demand trends: full year 2019 World Gold Council / 2020-01-30 https://www.gold.org/goldhub/research/gold-demand-trends/gold-demand-trends-full-year-2019
S24	Gold prices swing as markets sell off World Gold Council / 2020-03-19 https://www.gold.org/goldhub/research/gold-prices-swing-as-markets-sell-off
S25	Low liquidity and limited storage pushed WTI futures below zero U.S. Energy Information Administration / 2020-04-27 https://www.eia.gov/todayinenergy/detail.php?id=43495
S26	Global liquid fuels consumption returned toward 2019 levels U.S. Energy Information Administration / 2021-11-09 https://www.eia.gov/todayinenergy/detail.php?id=50296

S27	Staff report on equity and options market structure conditions in early 2021 U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission / 2021-10-18 https://www.sec.gov/about/reports-publications/staff-report-equity-options-market-structure-conditions-early-2021
S28	Cboe VIX FAQ: definition, calculation and products Cboe / 2018-05-15 https://www.cboe.com/tradable_products/vix/faqs
S29	FOMC projections materials Federal Reserve / 2021-12-15 https://www.federalreserve.gov/monetarypolicy/fomcproptabl20211215.htm
S30	Crude oil prices were lower in 2022 than in 2021 by year end U.S. Energy Information Administration / 2023-01-04 https://www.eia.gov/todayinenergy/detail.php?id=55079
S31	Gold market commentary: December 2022 World Gold Council / 2023-01-09 https://www.gold.org/goldhub/research/gold-market-commentary-december-2022

Calibration data

S32	FRED U.S. dollars to euro exchange rate series DEXUSEU Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis / accessed 2026-07-10 https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/DEXUSEU
S33	Cushing WTI spot price history U.S. Energy Information Administration / accessed 2026-07-10 https://www.eia.gov/dnav/pet/hist/rwtcd.htm
S34	VIX historical data Cboe / accessed 2026-07-10 https://www.cboe.com/tradable_products/vix/vix_historical_data